

- ▶ What if, during the process of installation, you upgraded something and that made the situation worse?
- ▶ In case you're guiding a person, instructing him remotely and he doesn't understand half the things are talking about, it is going to be confusing and frustrating as well!

The solution is – simply setup a virtual machine and hand it over to your friend! This way, you save time as well as a lot of headache which comes with helping a person remotely. Also, you need not be in his home for the night sitting in front of his PC; it can be done on your computer. There is no problem if he doesn't have an internet connection either – you simply have to install the software on your computer and then hand him over the files along with the setup file of your virtualization software. You don't have to risk breaking his current installation either.

See? Virtualization is bliss here, isn't it? It solves too many problems and rather complex ones in a simple go. There are simply a lot of ways virtualization helps you help others.

It is also useful for people who like to have their working environment with them. Obviously laptops are a solution but there are times when you just want to enjoy the feel of a PC. It might also be possible that you have two desktop PCs but no laptop! In such cases, just install the same virtualization software on both the computers and install a virtual machine and all the required software inside it. Now you can copy the virtual machine's installation directory in an external hard disk and you have the working environment wherever you go and there is no need to carry a big laptop when all that's needed is a small hard disk! In many ways, you're simply carrying your work environment with you and easily. The only trouble is to have the virtualization software on the end PCs. It's great for the nomad types. Note that virtual machines don't perform well over USB pen drives. So you can use a USB pen drive for copying the virtual machine's files but running a virtual machine straight through a USB pen drive would give you a bad performance hit. We would not recommend that you use USB pen drives for running virtual machines directly from them unless you don't have other options.

Legacy Applications – in Legacy Operating Systems

Are you still addicted to words like NFS2SE, MARIO or MS Word 97? Well, they don't work on Windows 7, do they? What about a really old accounting application? That won't work either. Still, men are made of habits and habits don't change easily - that includes our addiction to old applications. At times